

Tessera Regulatory Products — Africa Country Checklists

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Tessera should lead with tax e-invoicing built into its POS and invoicing products, add a licence tracker and data-protection toolkit, and win one regulator pilot on the side. Expand country by country: Kenya first, then Uganda and Rwanda, then Tanzania and Zambia, with Ghana and Nigeria once there is a local partner.

Every African market in this document now requires or is phasing in electronic tax invoicing, and each has a data protection law with a regulator. Those two rules are the repeatable pattern Tessera can build once and localise. This is a planning aid, not legal or tax advice; confirm each item with a local lawyer and tax adviser before selling in that country.

Products to offer

Five products sit on the same Tessera Core; the first four sell to businesses, the fifth to regulators.

Product	Buyer	What it does	Sales cycle	Start
E-invoicing connector	Any VAT-registered business; your POS and invoicing clients	Sends every invoice to the tax authority and prints the QR code, per country	Weeks	Now (Kenya), then country by country
Licence and permit tracker	SMEs, chains, pharmacies, liquor stores, clinics	Stores licences, tracks expiry dates, sends SMS or WhatsApp reminders	Days to weeks	Now
Data protection toolkit	SMEs, schools, clinics, SACCOs	Register of personal data held, consent log, access and deletion requests, breach log	Weeks	Months 3 to 6
AML compliance (non-bank businesses)	Lawyers, accountants, real estate agents, car and precious-metal dealers	Client ID checks, record keeping, sanctions screening, draft suspicious-transaction reports	1 to 3 months	Months 6 to 12
Tessera Workflow for regulators	Counties, professional bodies, sector regulators	Licence applications, inspections app, complaints, returns, QR licence verification	6 to 18 months (tenders)	One pilot in year 1

What changes per country: the tax authority's e-invoicing interface and certification, the data protection registration rules, mobile money providers, and which professions carry AML duties. Build each as a country setting inside Core, not a separate product.

Country overview

All seven markets run electronic tax invoicing through a tax-authority interface that third-party software can connect to; the certification route differs by country. Kenya is the only one of the seven on the FATF grey list after the June 2026 plenary.

Country	Priority	E-invoicing system (tax authority)	Software route	Data protection law and regulator	Payment rails	FATF grey list (Jun 2026)
Kenya	1	eTIMS (KRA)	OSCU / VSCU API; certified third-party integrator	Data Protection Act 2019, ODPC	M-Pesa, Airtel Money, banks	Yes
Uganda	2	EFRIS (URA)	System-to-system API; URA list of accredited integrators	Data Protection and Privacy Act 2019, PDPO (approx.)	MTN MoMo, Airtel Money	No
Rwanda	2	EBM / EIS (RRA)	OSDC (online) or VSDC (offline) API; RRA approval	Law 058/2021, NCSA (approx.)	MTN MoMo, Airtel Money	No
Tanzania	3	EFD / VFD, EFDMS (TRA)	TRA VFD API or approved VFD provider	Personal Data Protection Act 2022, PDPC (approx.)	M-Pesa, Airtel Money, Mixx by Yas	No
Zambia	3	Smart Invoice, VSDC (ZRA)	VSDC system-to-system API	Data Protection Act 2021, ODPC Zambia (approx.)	MTN MoMo, Airtel Money	No
Ghana	4	E-VAT, VSDC (GRA)	Certified Invoicing System on VSDC API	Data Protection Act 2012 (Act 843), DPC (approx.)	MTN MoMo, Telecel Cash	No
Nigeria	4	FIRS e-invoicing (MBS)	Access points; B2B clearance, B2C e-reporting within 24 hours	Nigeria Data Protection Act 2023, NDPC (approx.)	Bank transfer, cards, Paystack, Flutterwave	No

Data protection and payment details marked approximate come from general knowledge, not a page checked for this document; confirm them locally.

Kenya checklist

Kenya is the home market and the proving ground: every product launches here first.

Company and tax

- ☐ Register Tessera Tech Ltd, get KRA PIN, open business bank account and M-Pesa Paybill
- ☐ Register for AGPO if the owners qualify (youth, women or persons with disabilities) to bid for government contracts

E-invoicing (eTIMS)

- ☐ Read KRA's OSCU and VSCU specifications and build against the eTIMS sandbox
- ☐ Choose OSCU (always online) as the default route; VSCU only for clients who bill offline in bulk
- ☐ Apply for third-party integrator certification: company documents, CR12, proof of at least three qualified technical staff, solvency declaration
- ☐ Until certified, partner with a certified integrator and name them in proposals

Data protection

- ☐ Register with the ODPC as a data processor (mandatory above KSh 5M turnover or 10 staff, and in health, education and finance regardless of size)
- ☐ Write a standard data processing agreement for every client
- ☐ Build the data protection toolkit on top of Tessera's own compliance records

AML product

- ☐ Confirm with an advocate which professions are reporting institutions under current AML law
- ☐ Price a sanctions and PEP screening data feed before committing to the product
- ☐ Map the Financial Reporting Centre's reporting format for suspicious-transaction reports

Licence tracker and regulator pilot

- ☐ List the licences each target sector holds (county business permit, liquor, fire, public health, pharmacy, KRA tax compliance certificate) with renewal cycles
- ☐ Approach one county department or professional body for a Tessera Workflow pilot; national agencies are moving services to eCitizen, so start outside it

Uganda checklist

Uganda is the closest second market: EFRIS covers VAT-registered businesses (VAT threshold UGX 150M) and was expanded to 12 more sectors from 1 July 2025, with penalties up to double the tax due.

- ☐ Download URA's EFRIS system-to-system integration documents and UAT readiness checklist
- ☐ Apply to join URA's list of accredited EFRIS software integrators; confirm whether a local entity is required
- ☐ Decide on a Ugandan entity or a local reseller partner for sales, support and tax registration
- ☐ Integrate MTN MoMo and Airtel Money collections in Tessera Core
- ☐ Confirm registration duties with Uganda's Personal Data Protection Office before storing client data
- ☐ Localise invoices: UGX, Ugandan VAT rates, TIN format
- ☐ Sign one pilot client (a retailer or distributor already trading with Kenya is ideal)

Tanzania checklist

Tanzania requires all VAT-registered persons, and non-VAT traders above TZS 11M turnover, to issue receipts through EFDs or the software-based VFD, reported to TRA's EFDMS.

- ☐ Choose a route: integrate the TRA VFD API directly, or connect through one of the approved VFD providers
- ☐ Track the proposed move to token-based pre-clearance (invoices verified before the customer receives them); no effective date gazetted yet
- ☐ Handle the Finance Act 2025 changes: VAT withholding (3% goods, 6% services from July 2025) and a 16% VAT rate for electronically paid B2C sales from September 2025
- ☐ Integrate M-Pesa (Vodacom), Airtel Money and Mixx by Yas
- ☐ Register with the Personal Data Protection Commission before processing Tanzanian client data
- ☐ Offer a full Swahili interface
- ☐ Find a Tanzanian partner; many businesses expect a local company and office

Rwanda checklist

Rwanda's EBM system has been mandatory for registered taxpayers since January 2021, and it lets existing software connect through an online (OSDC) or offline (VSDC) sales data controller after RRA approval.

- ☐ Request OSDC or VSDC integration approval from RRA's certification desk (cis_sde_certification@rra.gov.rw)
- ☐ Read RRA's EBM requirements
- ☐ Note the VAT registration threshold: FRW 20M a year or FRW 5M in the previous quarter
- ☐ Integrate MTN MoMo and Airtel Money
- ☐ Confirm data protection registration with the National Cyber Security Authority; check rules on storing personal data outside Rwanda

- ☐ Add French and Kinyarwanda interface options if targeting SMEs outside Kigali
- ☐ Consider Kigali as a base for government and regulator work; Rwanda is known for digitising public services

Zambia checklist

Zambia's Smart Invoice has been mandatory for all VAT-registered taxpayers since 1 July 2024, with no turnover threshold, and since 1 January 2025 buyers can only deduct input VAT and expenses backed by Smart Invoice documents.

- ☐ Integrate through ZRA's VSDC system-to-system API; contact ZRA's integration support desk for test access
- ☐ Cover the other taxes that must use Smart Invoice: turnover tax, rental income, insurance premium levy, tourism levy
- ☐ Pitch the rental income rule to landlords and property managers alongside Tessera Property later
- ☐ Integrate MTN MoMo and Airtel Money
- ☐ Confirm registration with Zambia's Office of the Data Protection Commissioner
- ☐ Localise to ZMW and ZRA TPIN format

Ghana checklist

Ghana requires every VAT-registered business, including the flat rate scheme, to issue invoices through a Certified Invoicing System connected to GRA's VSDC, which signs each invoice and returns a QR code.

- ☐ Ask GRA how software becomes a Certified Invoicing System and what testing is required
- ☐ Build to the VSDC API (JSON or XML); offline systems must transmit within 24 hours of reconnecting
- ☐ Follow the VAT reforms passed in November 2025 (Covid-19 levy removed, changes to GETFund and NHIL levies) and update tax calculations
- ☐ Integrate MTN MoMo and Telecel Cash
- ☐ Register with Ghana's Data Protection Commission
- ☐ Enter through a Ghanaian partner; Ghana is far from Tessera's base

Nigeria checklist

Nigeria is the largest market but the hardest entry; e-invoicing applies to companies over ₦5bn revenue since November 2025, ₦1–5bn from 1 July 2026 (penalties after six months' grace), and smaller firms from July 2027.

- ☐ Decide whether to become an approved access point or connect through an existing one
- ☐ Support both flows: B2B invoices cleared by FIRS before issue, and B2C sales e-reported within 24 hours with a QR code
- ☐ Target the July 2027 wave (small businesses) with POS and invoicing, when competition from enterprise vendors is lowest
- ☐ Integrate Paystack or Flutterwave, bank transfers and cards; mobile money plays a smaller role than in East Africa
- ☐ Check whether Tessera counts as a data controller or processor "of major importance" requiring NDPC registration
- ☐ Enter only with a Nigerian partner company; do not build a Nigerian sales team in year 1

Sources

- [KRA: eTIMS system-to-system integration](#)
- [KRA eTIMS taxpayer portal: integrator certification](#)

- [ODPC FAQs](#)
- [AML UAE: FATF grey list update, June 2026](#)
- [Greytrix: Guide to e-invoicing in Africa 2026](#)
- [URA: EFRIS UAT readiness checklist](#)
- [URA: Accredited EFRIS software integrators](#)
- [EDICOM: Mandatory e-invoicing in Rwanda](#)
- [RRA: About EBM](#)
- [VATupdate: Tanzania e-invoicing booklet](#)
- [VATupdate: Zambia e-invoicing booklet](#)
- [Fonoa: Ghana E-VAT e-invoicing](#)
- [vatcalc: Nigeria FIRS e-invoicing](#)